

PASTOR'S MESSAGE



2020 was a challenging year. The pandemic changed the way we were used to living our lives. Simple tasks, like going to the grocery store or the doctor's office, became very difficult. The isolation and social distancing removed us from important interactions and precious relationships. Adding to this pressure is the "unknown" about the future – when will this end? When can we return to "normal?"

2020 has been challenging for the church as well. We "do" church differently. About 70% of our people are worshiping from home. We miss them, and we miss our fellowship with them. And I know they miss being in church and miss the fellowship. This is what a pandemic does to us.

Yet, as much as we have worked through the challenges of living through a pandemic, we are the first to have ever struggled. Jesus Christ came to this world with a mission to save us through his death on the cross and his resurrection. Jesus knew that plan. But on the eve of his crucifixion, Jesus struggled. He struggled mightily. In the Gospel of Luke we read: "[Jesus] withdrew about a stone's throw beyond [the disciples], knelt down and prayed, "Father, if you are willing, take this cup from me; yet not my will, but yours be done." An angel from heaven appeared to him and strengthened him. And being in anguish, he prayed more earnestly, and his sweat was like drops of blood falling to the ground." (Luke 22:41-44) Jesus, in his human nature, struggled with the situation before him. So much so, he sweat drops of blood. And yet, Jesus knew that God's plan for salvation was unfolding. As difficult and as challenging as the present situation was, Jesus faced the cross for us.

Jesus sweat blood. What makes you sweat? **"What Makes You Sweat?"** That will be our Wednesday evening Lenten theme this

year! What caused God's people to sweat, and how did God respond to their need?

Lenten Worship Schedule

All services 7:00 P.M. All services live-streamed

Ash Wednesday February 17

"What Makes You Sweat?"

Lent 1 February 24 "The Storms of Life" Luke 8:22-25

Lent 2 March 3 "Tests" Matthew 14:29-31

Lent 3 March 10 "Finances: Who's in Charge?" Luke 12:16-21

Lent 4 March 17 "Hitting the Wall" Exodus 14:21-22

Lent 5 March 24 "The Future" Jeremiah 29:11

Maundy Thursday April 1

Good Friday April 2

Easter 8:30 and 11:00 A.M. April 4

God's Peace this Lenten Season,

Pastor Andrew C. Lissy